



The science of dirty thunderstorms

Learn more about the science behind these spectacular phenomena at insane charges and temperatures. <https://digit.in/jan20-35>



Pliny the Younger's letters

The first hand account of what happened during the Vesuvius eruption in 79 AD. <https://digit.in/jan20-36>



Volcanic lightning, also known as dirty thunderstorms are a natural phenomenon that takes place when large amounts of volcanic ash, dust, volatile gasses, rock and lava are expelled during volcanic discharge and generate static electricity within the plume.

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Credit: Forbes

Photographer and videographer, Marco Fulle, captured this image of volcanic lightning above an Icelandic volcano on March 20, 2010, while flying in a helicopter.



Credit: Forbes

The Chilean volcano named Calbuco erupted for the first time in a span of 42 years in 2015. Volcanic lightning was recorded during the eruption. While it looked stunning, the eruption caused widespread damage in and around the area.



Credit: Wikipedia

One of the earliest observations of volcanic lightning was supposedly from Pliny the Younger who described seeing a "transient blaze of lightning" during the eruption of Mount Vesuvius in 79 AD.



Credit: Forbes

Japan's most active volcano, Sakurajima, is notorious for dirty thunderstorms. The volcano often produces a spectacular display of bright lightning strikes along with lava and ash plume reaching up to three miles in the air.



Credit: Reuters

German photographer, Martin Reitze, captured rare images of the exact moment a lightning bolt struck the volcanic ash escaping from Ebeko volcano in Russia. He was standing merely a kilometre away from the northern crater of the volcano when he captured the shot.



Credit: Forbes

Often volcanic lightning occurs with multiple number of strikes. The Puyehue volcano in Chile is shown in this image, where an inordinately high number of lightning strikes occurred within a short span.



Credit: Good News Network

In the Ketep village in Magelang located in Indonesia's Central Java province, volcanic lightning struck Mount Merapi on November 6, 2010.